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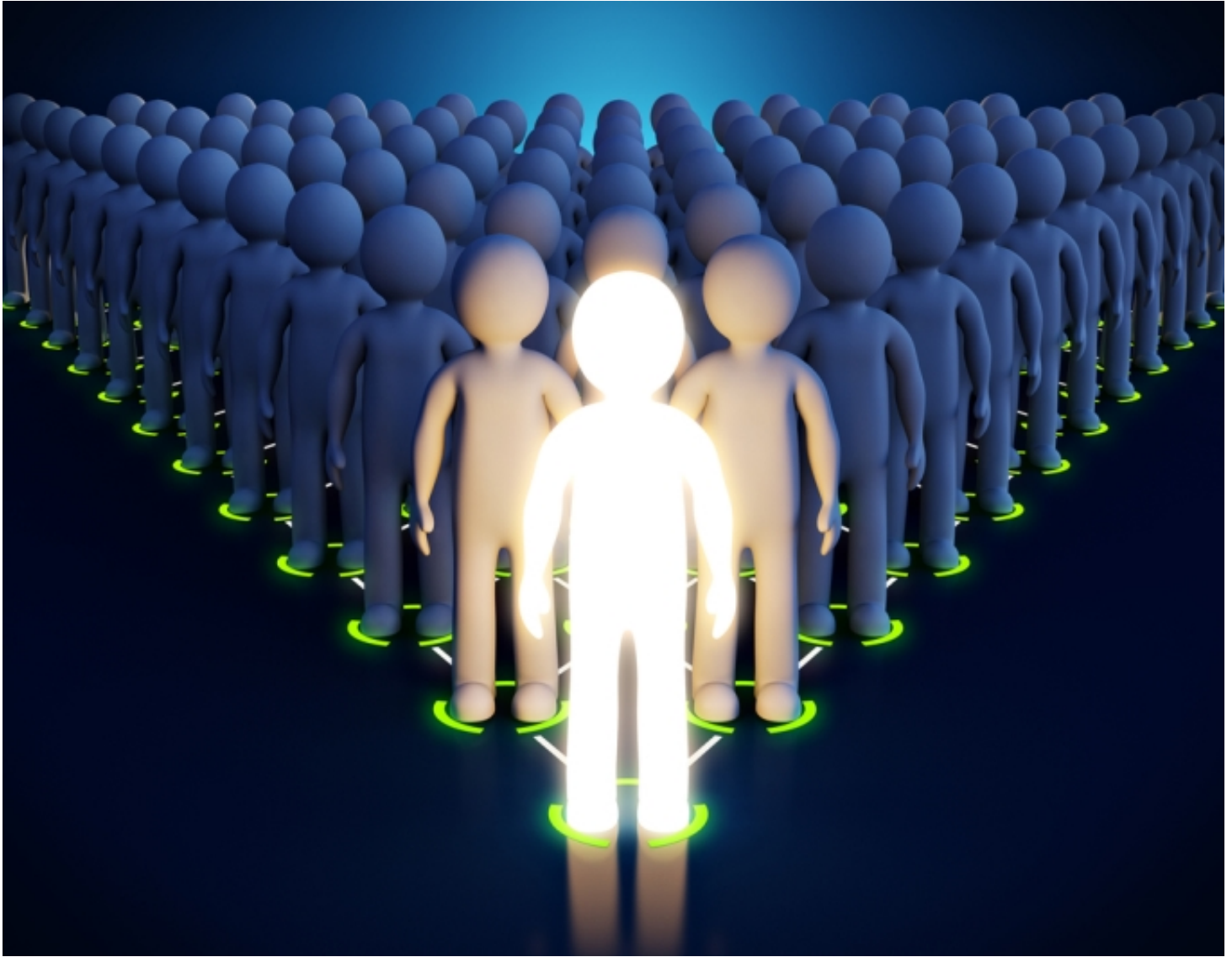
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11 Ways to Generate Leads Online – Part I



By **Chaz Wilke**, Staff Writer

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Organic lead generation can prove an effective way to gather leads. By using the tactics outlined below you may find that the leads you generate might convert in larger quantities and potentially return as repeat customers more so than if you just purchased these leads.

Blogging

Creating meaningful and useful content will never go out of style. Generating leads online is done by first generating interest in your brand, your voice and the site you present it all on. The frequency in which you write posts is less of a concern than the quality of each post. Daily blog posts can quickly become redundant if you have nothing new or important to say.

Also, be careful when adding keywords to your text. It's important that you write words that resonate with your readers. What's less important is maintaining a keyword density in your content of 3-7%, as some would

advise. Tricking the search engines to rank you higher is less important than capturing the attention of the red-blooded humans who are visiting your site.

Remember, these leads that you are generating are actual people, not a commodity. Your readership has a choice, and the sheer number of blogs covering just about all topics makes it difficult to stand out among the competition. Make sure you approach each blog post with respect for the audience that you hope to attract. The leads you hope to generate are people who need to be persuaded.



PPC

Pay per Click advertising remains a valid tactic to drive traffic and generate leads online. PPC advertising's greatest strength is that it allows local lead generation through your campaign's geographic parameters. Most PPC platforms, including Google's AdWords, allow you to create geographic boundaries that determine who sees your ad. This helps keep costs down while you are able to target local lead generation and attract the local leads you want.

As a matter of saving money when using PPC, consider long-tail keywords, which are multi-keyword

phrases. Brett Prince, president of [Marketaire](#), suggests, "Long-tail keyword phrases drive targeted traffic due to their specificity, and they're less competitive than related, shorter search terms, which tend to be higher in volume and more competitive." They will likely be cheaper than more competitive keywords.



Podcasting

Podcasting is a helpful tool to increase brand recognition and rapport with your prospects. By creating these downloadable Internet radio programs, you can extend your reach to those on the go who are too busy to sit and read your blog posts.

Zac Johnson, a prominent affiliate marketer, runs the podcast [Rise of the Entrepreneur](#). In it, he talks about affiliate marketing and smart ways to generate leads. "The concept of the show is simple... real life interviews and stories with some of the world's greatest entrepreneurs," says Johnson.

The cost of creating a podcast can be as minimal as buying a microphone and hitting "Record," provided you already have a computer and an Internet connection along with some podcast recording and editing software - see more about that [here](#). Listen to Johnson's podcast to get an idea of how to effectively create an effective episode. Most podcast episodes focus on one central topic and generally run from 30 minutes to an hour.

Twitter

One of Twitter's greatest strengths is that it allows you to tag and talk to anyone on the platform. Twitter doesn't use friend-confirmation barriers like Facebook so you are free to interact with anyone who has an account. This means you can mention or speak to any of [271 million monthly active users](#) per Twitter's own count.

Twitter's ecosystem creates a goldmine of networking and lead generating opportunities. Your message can dramatically rise in popularity and reach when someone simply retweets it. You can also use hashtags to increase your messages' visibility. And best of all, this service is free. There is no reason for you to not include Twitter in your lead generation efforts.

Takeaway

Not all of these methods of generating leads may work with your current business plan, but we're hoping these have inspired you to take another look at how you are generating leads online. Perhaps we have inspired you to take a chance at incorporating new methods.

We'll be back with part two of this two part series where we look at great ways to generate leads online. Those tactics include making videos, running contests and how to effectively use customer testimonials and referrals to generate leads.

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Hailing from Chicago and a product of the Illinois public school system, Chaz Wilke is a professional writer who has written for newspaper, TV, radio, video games, blogs, and film. In his spare time, Chaz enjoys hiking and discovering the hidden gems and oddities of Los Angeles. He also juggles.

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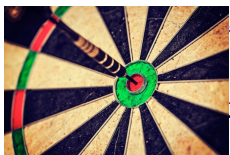
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